

05 Making general statements

It is very useful to know how to start sentences with the word "it" in English. You can use "it is" at the beginning of a sentence to make a general statement about something.

-  **New language** Introductory "it"
-  **Vocabulary** Talents and abilities
-  **New skill** Expressing general truths

5.1 KEY LANGUAGE INTRODUCTORY "IT"

Certain set phrases beginning "it is" can be used at the start of a sentence. "It" is the subject of the sentence, and can be used to express a general truth or belief.



"IT" CLAUSE

INFINITIVE CLAUSE

It is easy **to** make mistakes in a new language.

Some "it" clauses are generally followed by a "to" infinitive.

"IT" CLAUSE

"THAT" CLAUSE

It is a shame **that** so many people give up.

Some "it" clauses are often followed by "that" clauses.



5.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES INTRODUCTORY "IT"



It is important **to** be relaxed about making mistakes.



It is essential **to** give yourself time to study regularly.



It's true **that** being able to speak a second language is useful.



It's unlikely **that** you will be comfortable speaking aloud at first.



It is difficult **to** remember new words if you don't write them down.

